The Basket Team Story

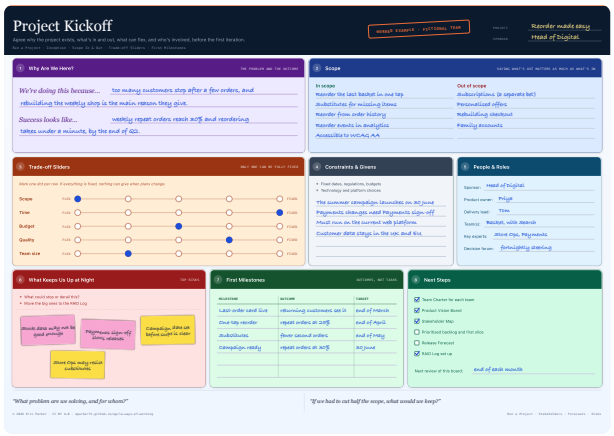
Every worked example in the toolkit, in the order it happened: one fictional team at an online grocery service, from launching in February to closing out in July. Read it as a case study of the tools working together. Each step opens the filled-in board, with a link back to the blank one. Short on time? Read the highlights: twelve moments and what they teach.

Online, with every board full size: eparker71.github.io/agile-ways-of-working/basket-team-story.html

The cast. The Basket team: Priya (product owner), Sam and Jo (developers), Alex (tester), Mei (designer), Tom (Scrum Master), and Ravi (developer, from March). Around them: the Head of Digital (sponsor), and the Checkout, Payments, Search & Browse, Store Platform and Warehouse teams. **The goal:** make the weekly shop effortless, so repeat orders rise from 22% to 30%.

February · Getting started

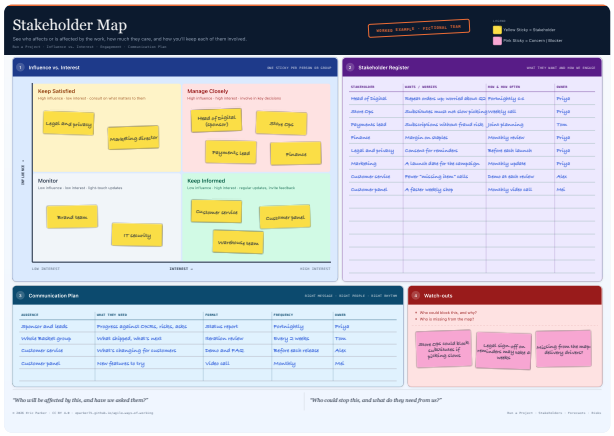
3 Feb



Project Kickoff

The Head of Digital sponsors “Reorder made easy”: repeat orders from 22% to 30% by the end of June, with only the campaign date fixed.

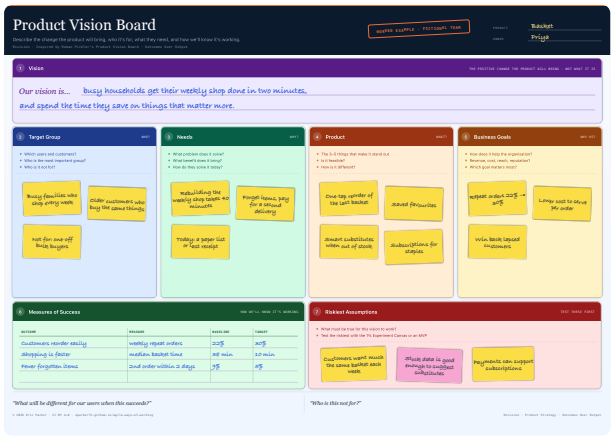
5 Feb



Stakeholder Map

Eleven stakeholders go on the map. Store Ops and Legal could block it, so they get the closest attention.

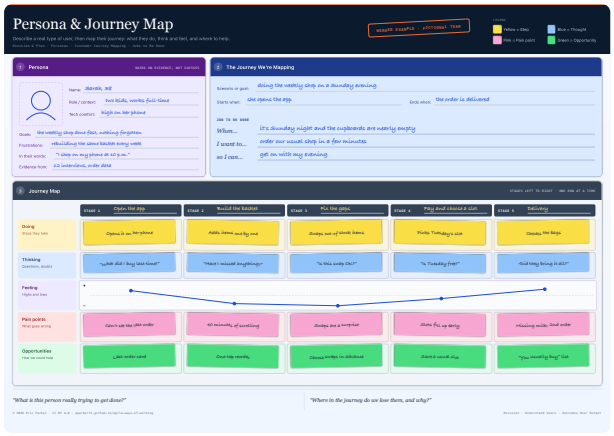
6 Feb



Product Vision Board

Priya writes the vision: busy households get their weekly shop done in two minutes.

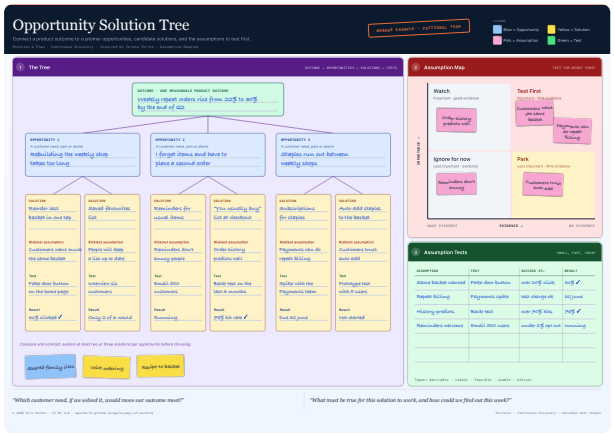
10 Feb



Persona & Journey Map

Twelve interviews become Sarah, 38, who rebuilds the same basket on her phone every Sunday night.

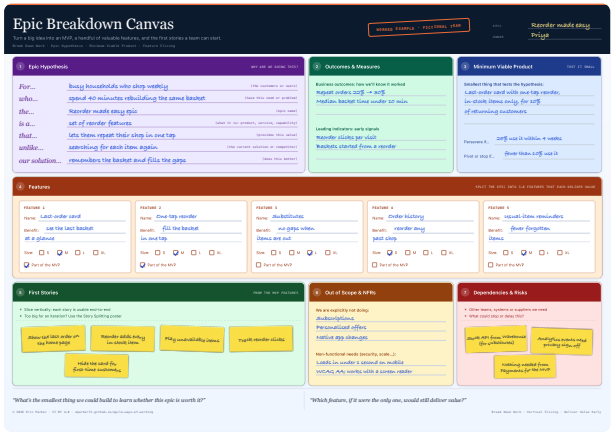
12 Feb



Opportunity Solution Tree

One outcome, three opportunities, six solutions. A fake-door button shows 31% of customers want one-tap reorder.

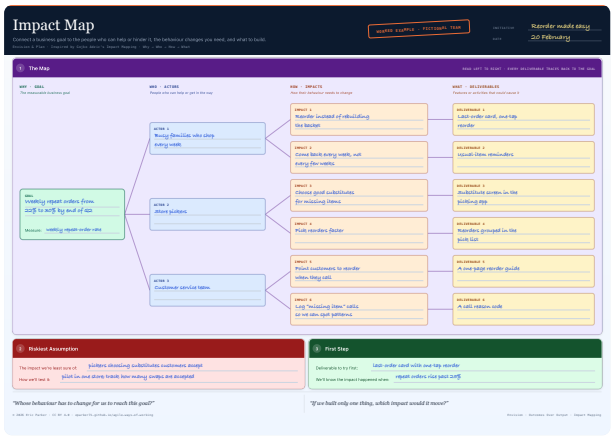
18 Feb



Epic Breakdown Canvas

The epic as a hypothesis, with an MVP: a last-order card and one-tap reorder for 10% of customers.

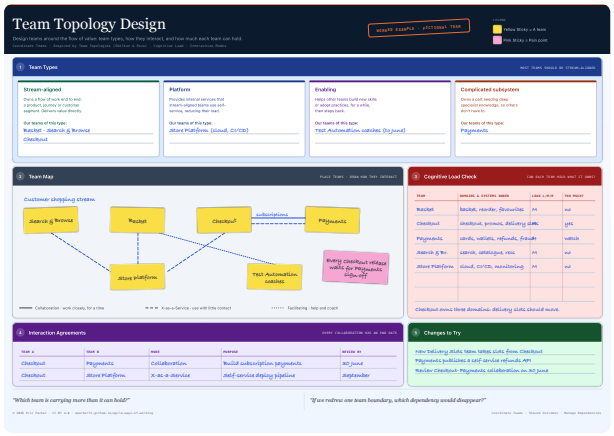
20 Feb



Impact Map

Families, pickers and customer service each need to behave differently; each gets a deliverable.

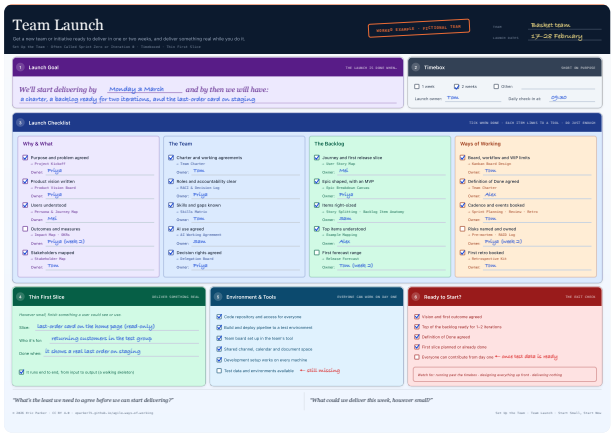
24 Feb



Team Topology Design

Four teams mapped by type. Checkout is carrying too much, and every release waits for Payments.

17–28 Feb

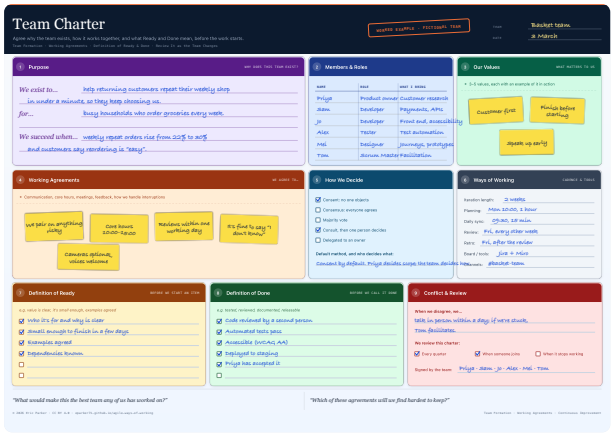


Team Launch (Sprint Zero)

A two-week launch: charter drafted, backlog ready, and the last-order card running on staging.

March · Forming the team

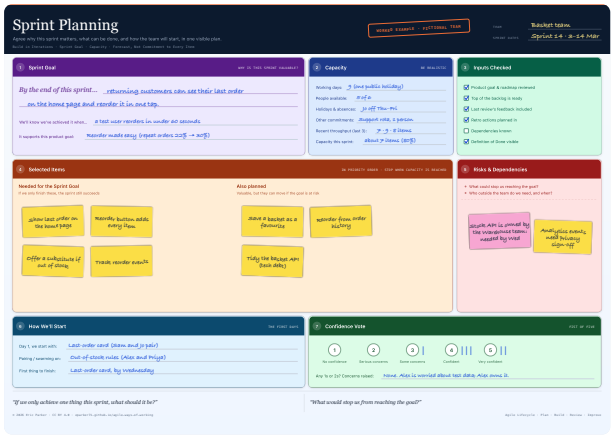
3 Mar



Team Charter

The Basket team agrees its purpose, values, working agreements and Definitions of Ready and Done.

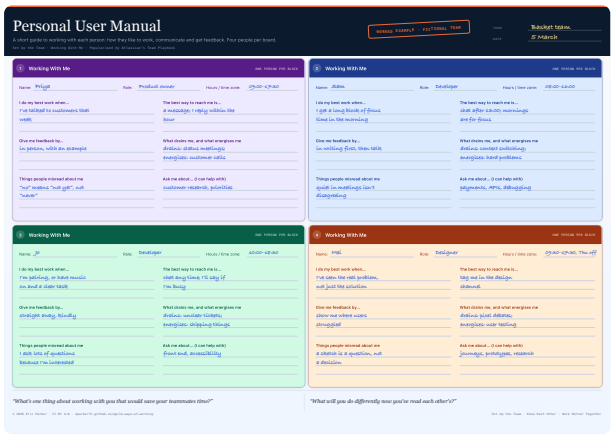
3 Mar



Sprint Planning

Sprint 14's goal: returning customers see their last order and reorder it in one tap.

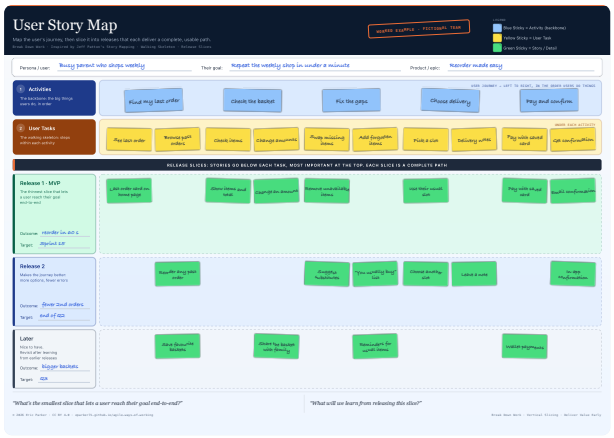
5 Mar



Personal User Manual

Priya, Sam, Jo and Mei write how to work with them: focus time, feedback, what drains them.

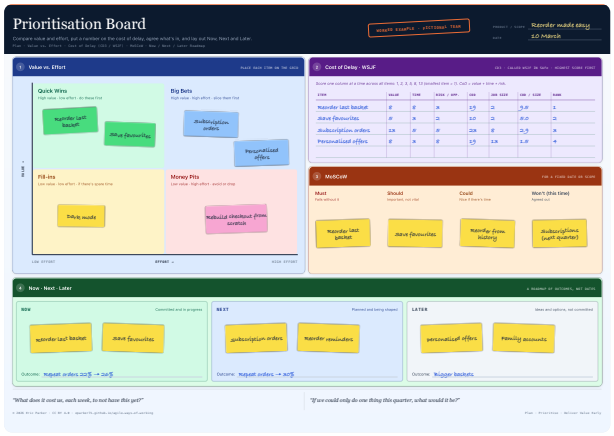
7 Mar



User Story Map

The reorder journey, sliced into an MVP, a second release and later.

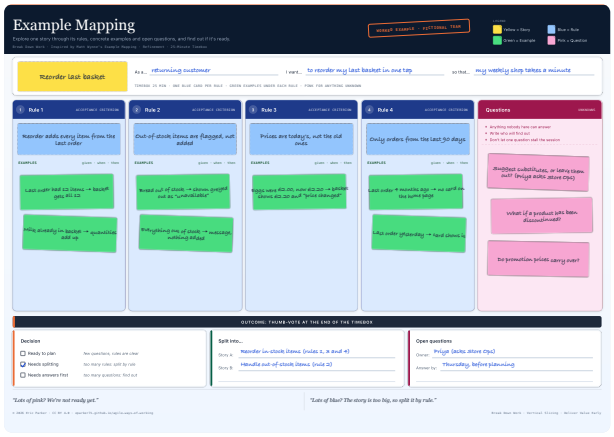
10 Mar



Prioritisation Board

Cost of delay ranks reorder first and subscriptions third; the Now · Next · Later plan follows.

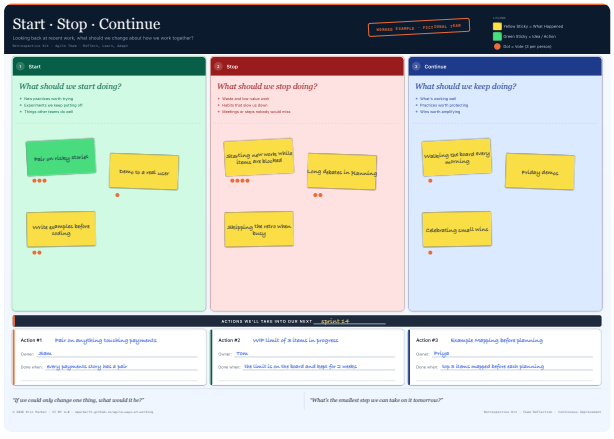
12 Mar



Example Mapping

“Reorder last basket” has four rules and three open questions, so it's split into two stories.

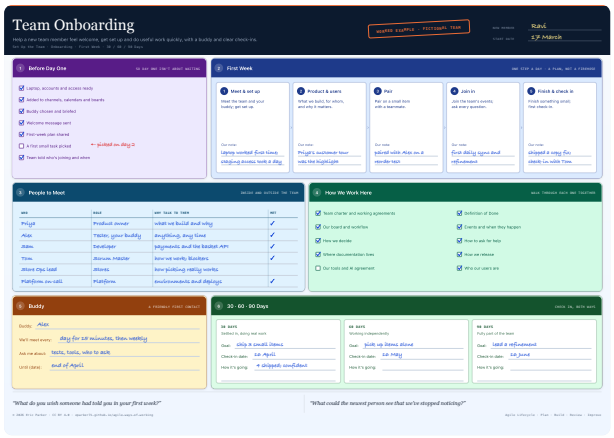
14 Mar



Start · Stop · Continue

Sprint 14's retro: stop starting new work while items are blocked; try Example Mapping before planning.

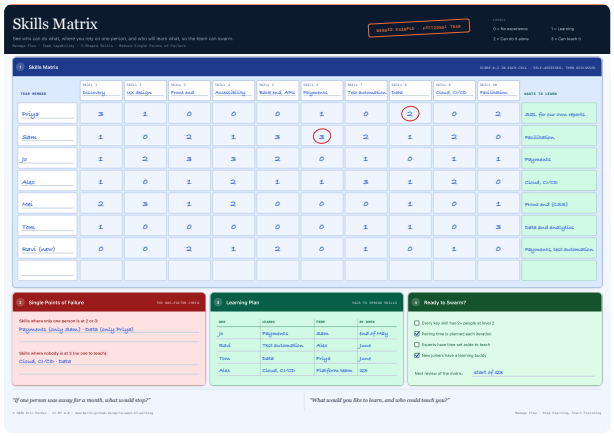
17 Mar



Team Onboarding

Ravi joins, with Alex as his buddy and a first week that ends with something shipped.

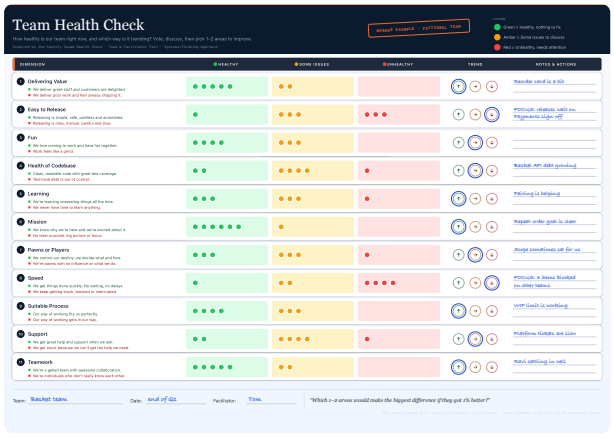
20 Mar



Skills Matrix

The skills matrix shows two single points of failure: only Sam knows payments, only Priya knows the data.

28 Mar

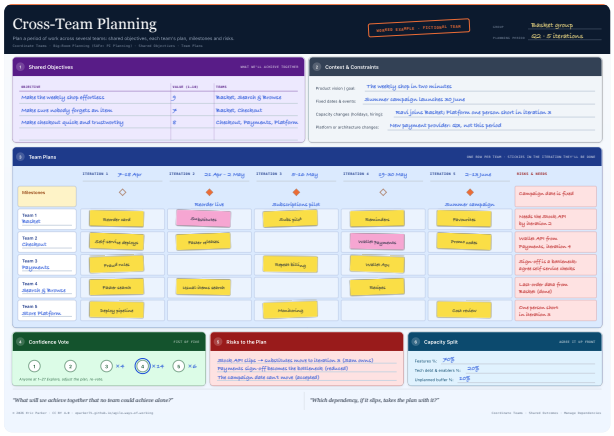


Team Health Check

End of the quarter: releases and waiting on other teams are the two areas to fix.

April · Delivering, and the first knocks

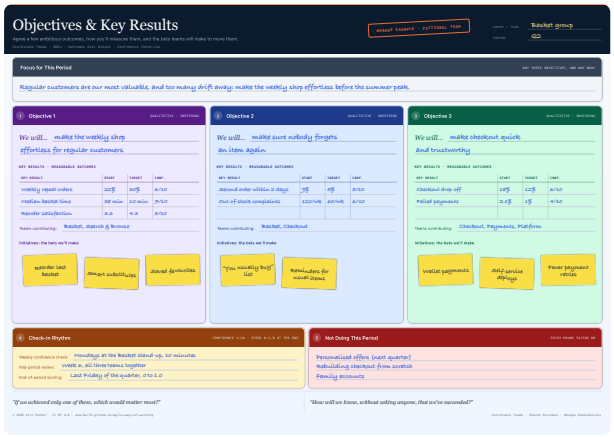
1 Apr



Cross-Team Planning

Five teams plan the quarter together around three shared objectives; confidence vote: 4.

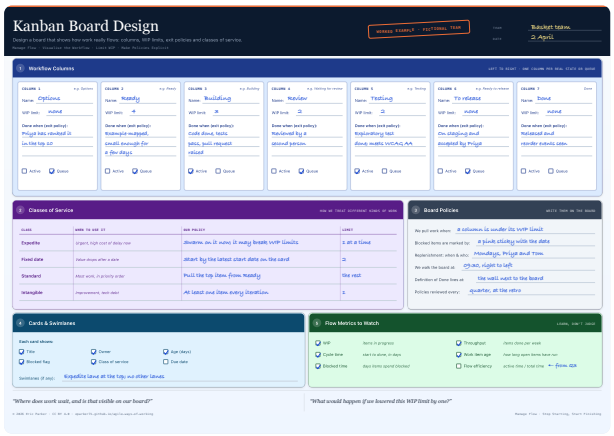
1 Apr



Objectives & Key Results

Three objectives for Q2, from effortless weekly shops to a quicker, trustworthy checkout.

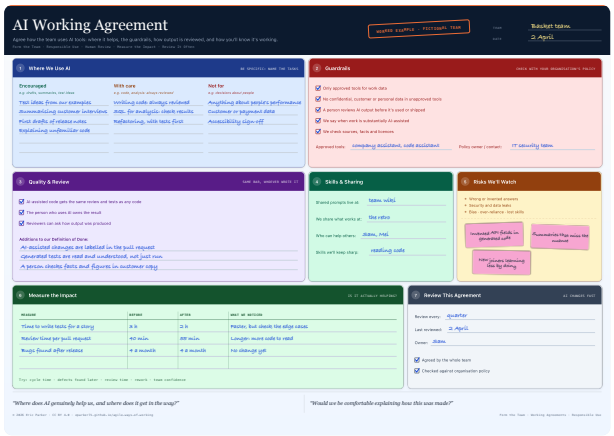
2 Apr



Kanban Board Design

The team redesigns its board: seven columns, WIP limits and exit policies.

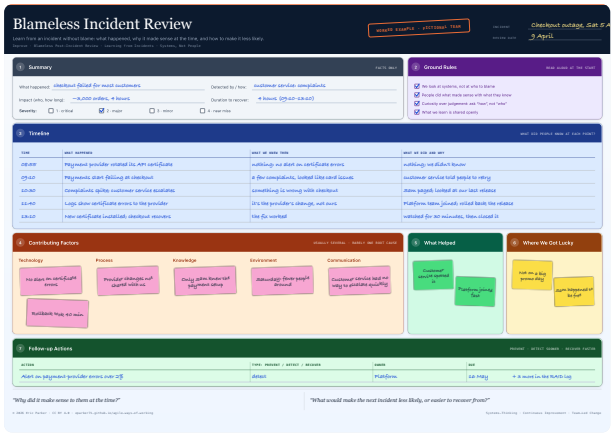
2 Apr



AI Working Agreement

The team agrees where AI helps, where it's off limits, and how its output is reviewed.

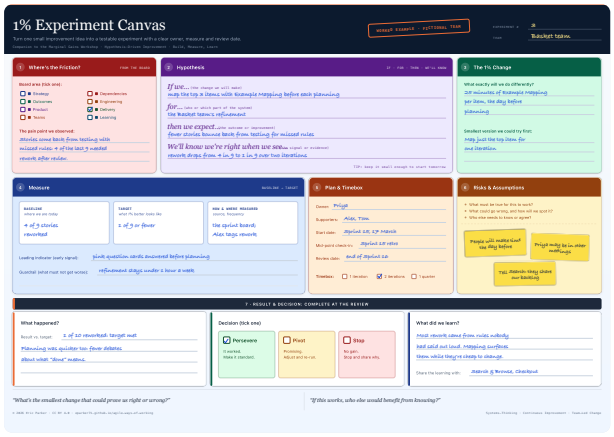
9 Apr



Blameless Incident Review

Saturday 5 April: checkout fails for four hours. The blameless review finds no alert on certificate errors.

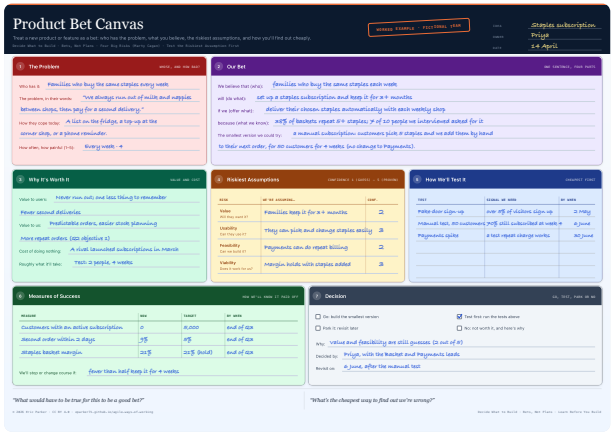
11 Apr



1% Experiment Canvas

Example Mapping before planning worked: rework fell from 4 in 9 stories to 1 in 10.

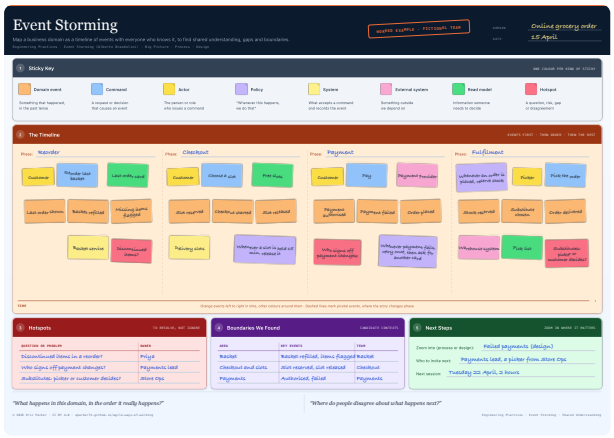
14 Apr



Product Bet Canvas

The staples subscription bet: test it by hand with 50 customers before building anything.

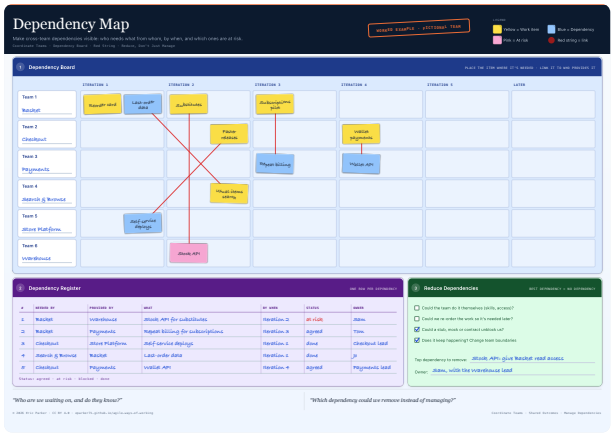
15 Apr



Event Storming

An order from reorder to delivery, mapped with Store Ops and Payments; three hotspots surface.

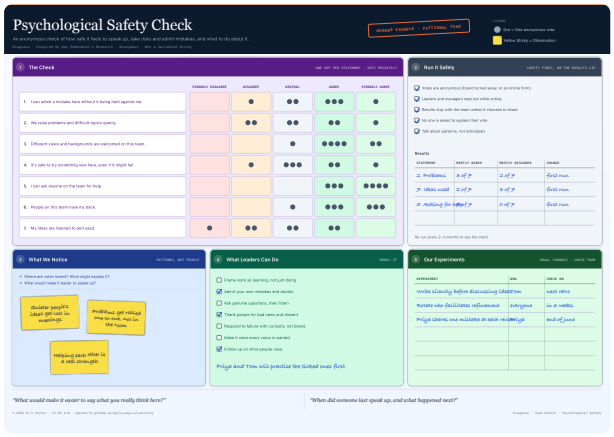
22 Apr



Dependency Map

Five dependencies across six teams; the Stock API that substitutes need is at risk.

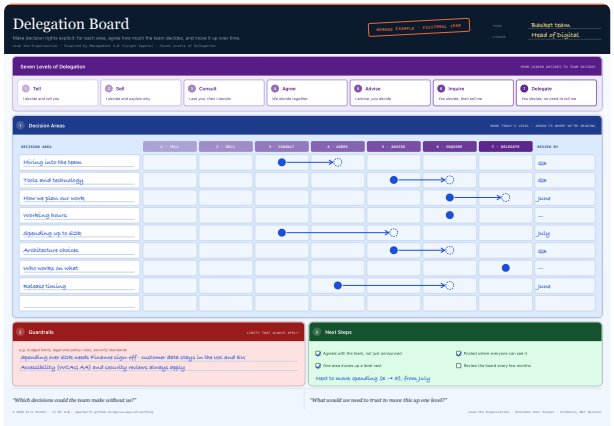
23 Apr



Psychological Safety Check

An anonymous check: problems are raised one to one, not in the room, so the team tries silent writing.

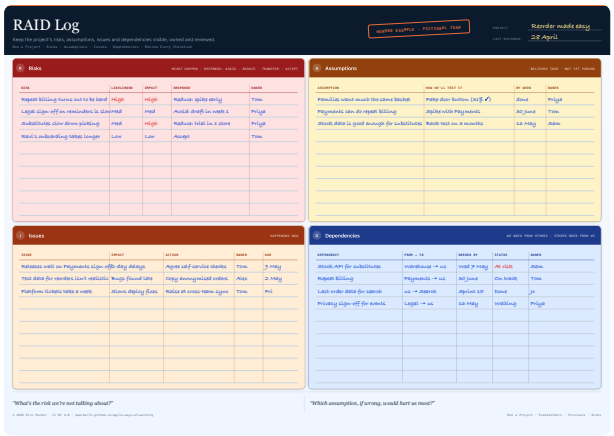
25 Apr



Delegation Board

Eight decision areas, and where each is heading; spending decisions move to the team in July.

28 Apr

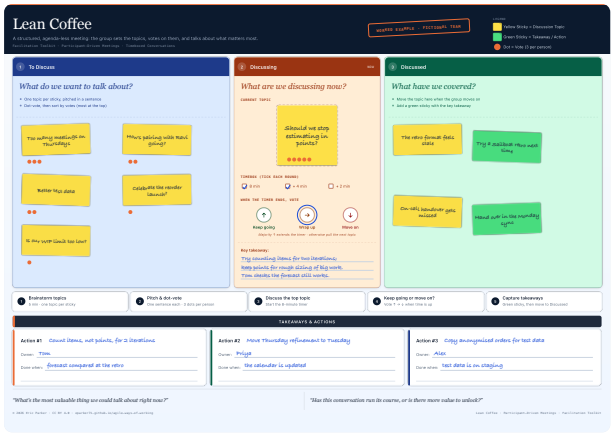


RAID Log

The RAID log: repeat billing is the biggest risk, the Stock API the dependency at risk.

May · Under pressure

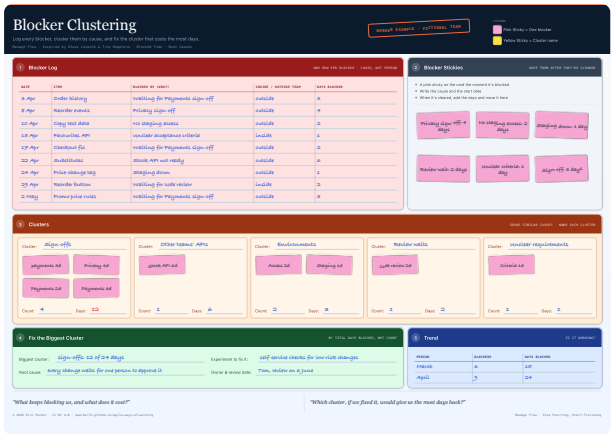
1 May



Lean Coffee

The team's own agenda: they'll try counting items instead of story points for two iterations.

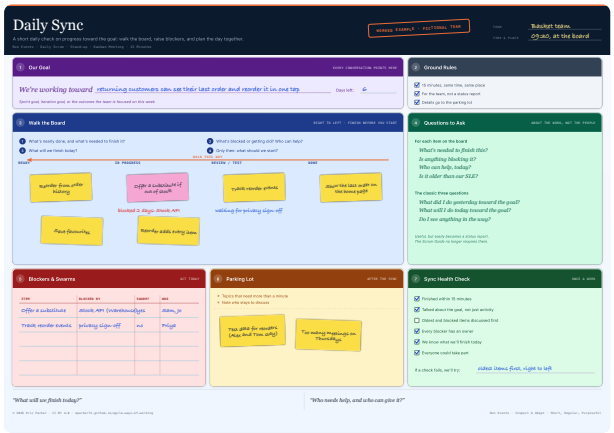
5 May



Blocker Clustering

April's blockers clustered: sign-offs cost 12 of 24 blocked days, so that's the one to fix.

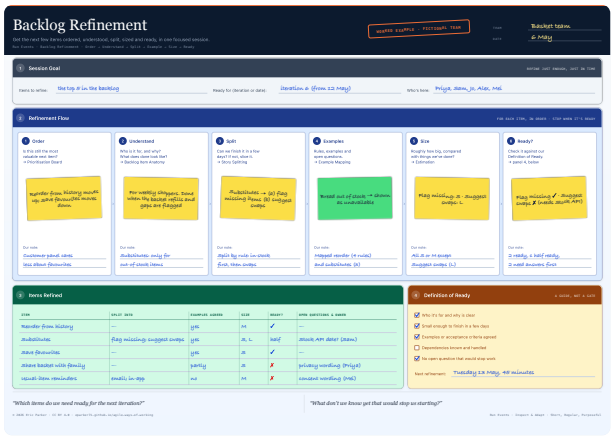
6 May



Daily Sync

Six days left in Sprint 18. Substitutes are blocked on the Stock API, so two people swarm on it.

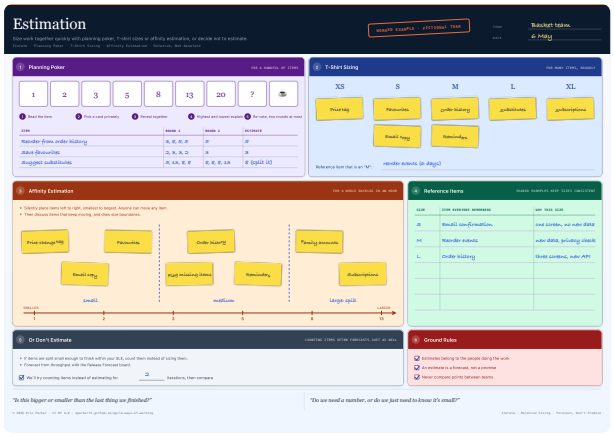
6 May



Backlog Refinement

Five items taken through order, understand, split, examples, size and ready.

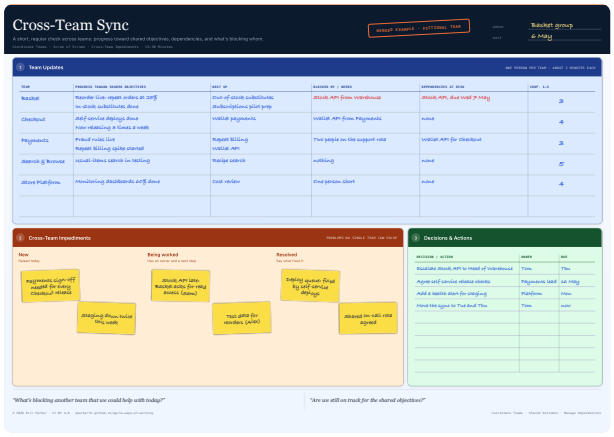
6 May



Estimation

Planning poker converges on most items; substitutes come out an 8, so they're split.

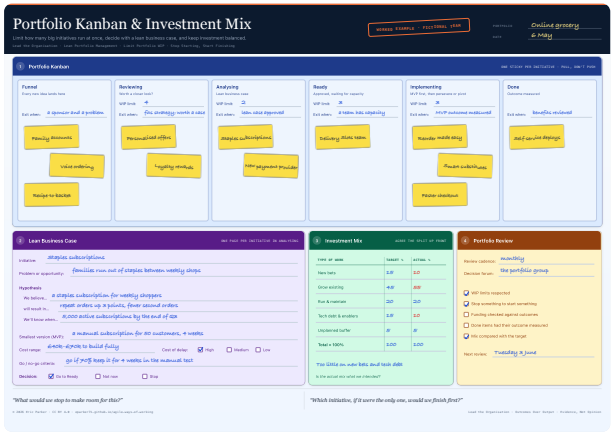
6 May



Cross-Team Sync

Five teams in 20 minutes: the Stock API is escalated, and release checks are agreed.

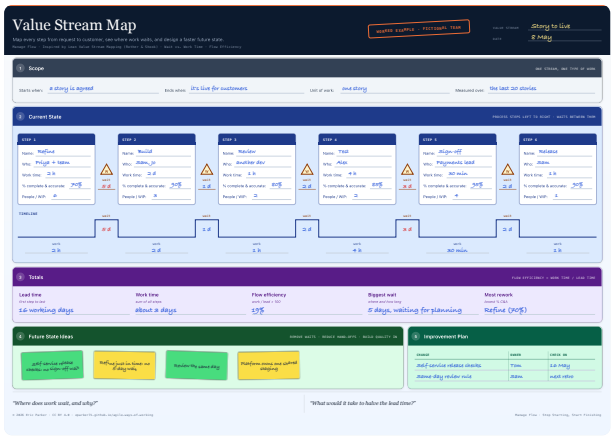
6 May



Portfolio Kanban & Investment Mix

Twelve initiatives, WIP limits, and an investment mix that's drifted from what was agreed.

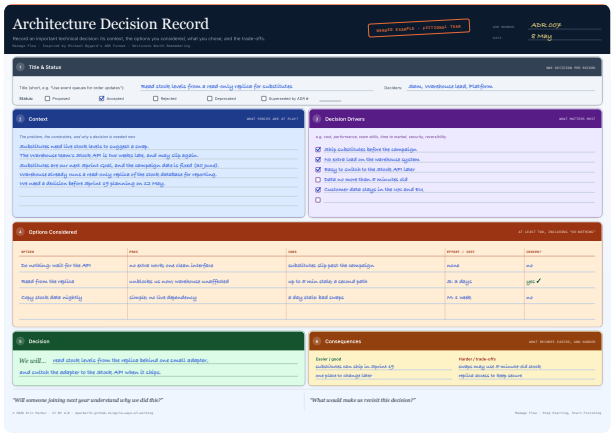
8 May



Value Stream Map

From story to live takes 16 days, and only 3 of them are work. The longest wait is before building starts.

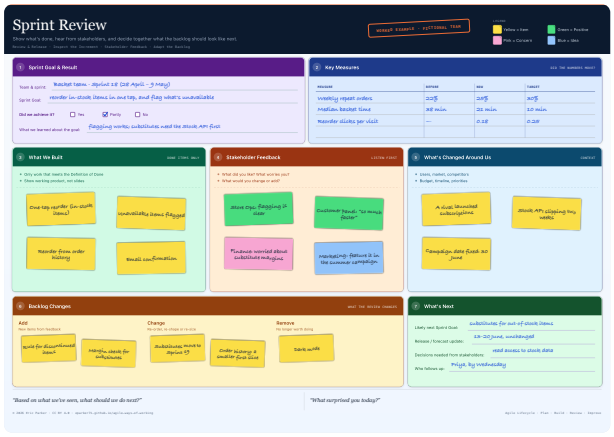
8 May



Architecture Decision Record

ADR 007: read stock levels from a replica behind an adapter, and switch to the API when it ships.

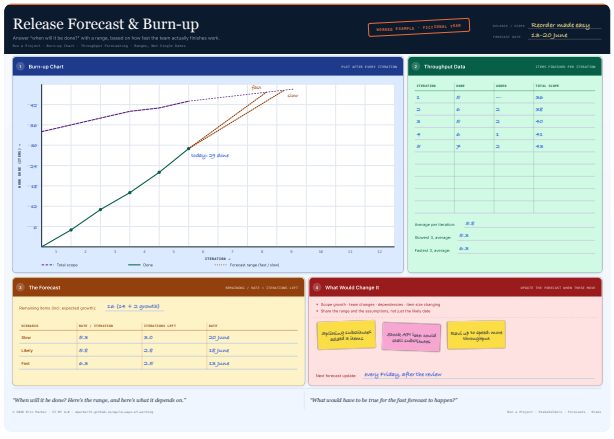
9 May



Sprint Review

Sprint 18 met its goal partly; stakeholders want substitutes, and Finance worries about margins.

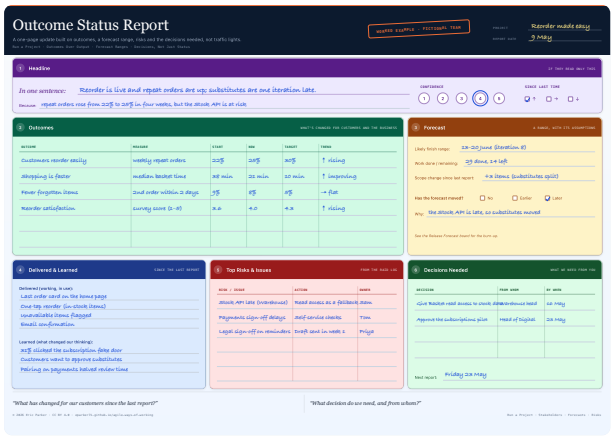
9 May



Release Forecast & Burn-up

29 items done, 14 left, with scope still growing: likely finish 13–20 June.

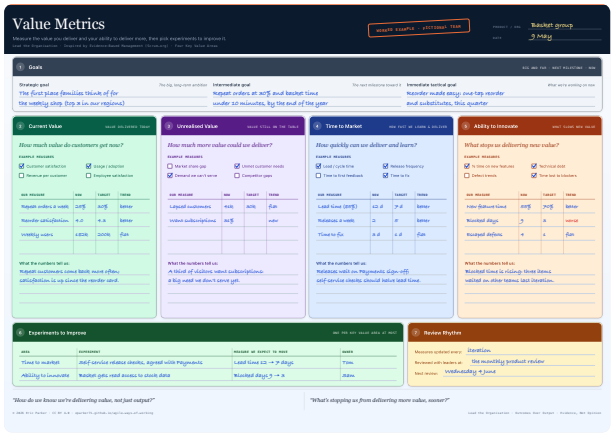
9 May



Outcome Status Report

Amber: reorder is live and repeat orders are at 25%, but substitutes are an iteration late.

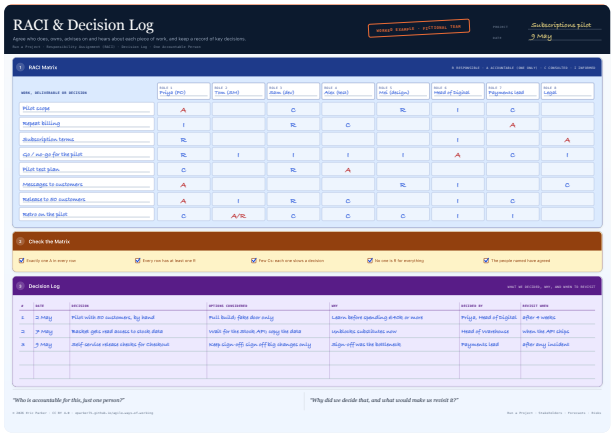
9 May



Value Metrics

Value metrics across the four areas: faster and more valued, but blocked time is rising.

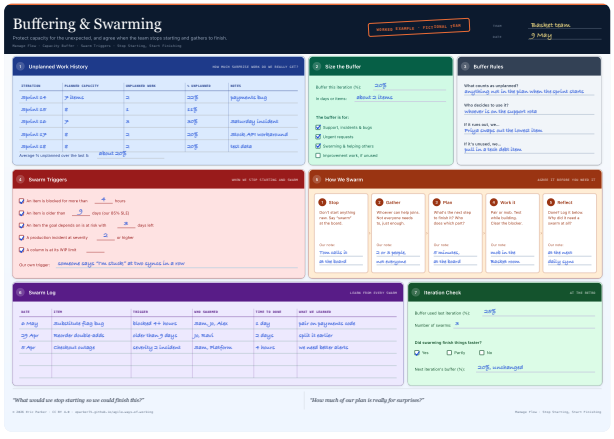
9 May



RACI & Decision Log

Who does what for the subscriptions pilot, and three decisions logged, including ADR 007.

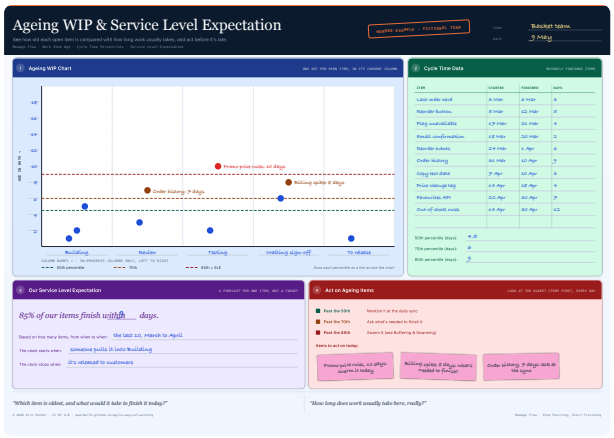
9 May



Buffering & Swarming

A 20% buffer, sized from five sprints of unplanned work, and swarm triggers with real numbers.

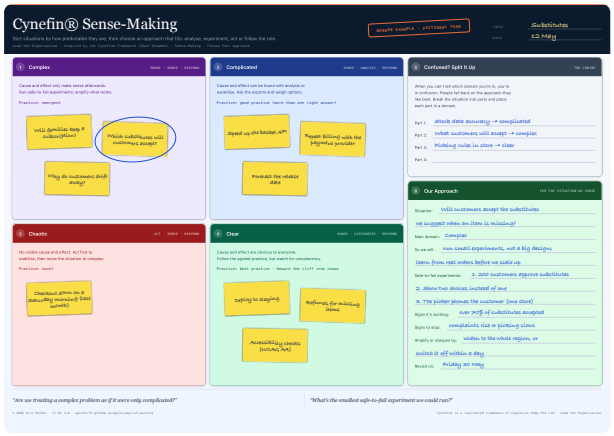
9 May



Ageing WIP & SLE

Three items are past the 9-day SLE; the oldest gets swarmed today.

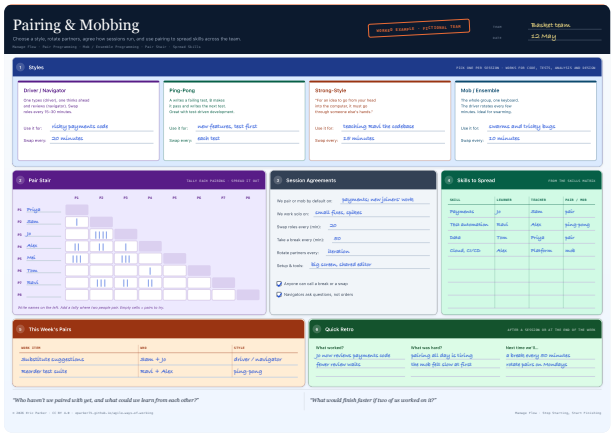
12 May



Cynefin® Sense-Making

Will customers accept substitutes? It's complex, so three safe-to-fail experiments, not a big design.

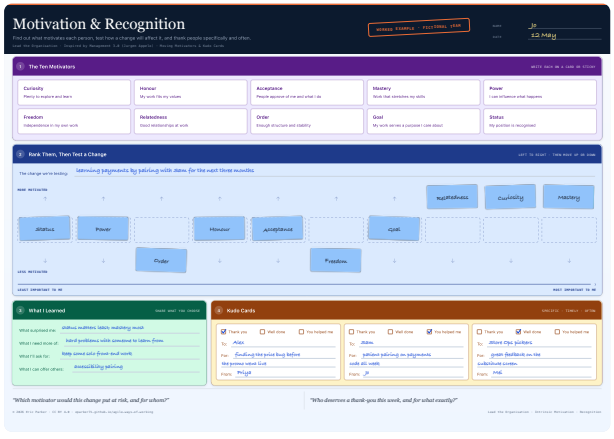
12 May



Pairing & Mobbing

A pair stair for seven people, and the skills from the matrix spread by pairing.

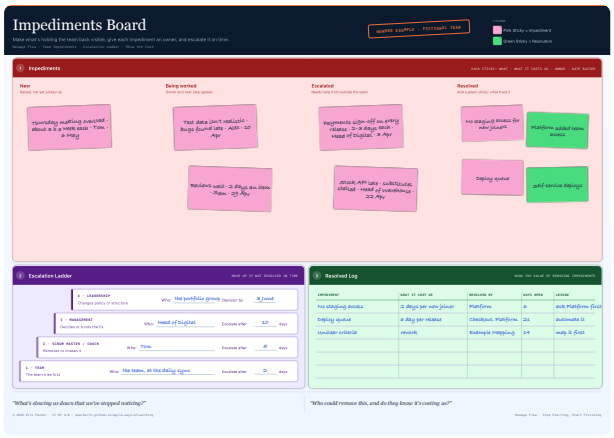
12 May



Motivation & Recognition

Jo ranks ten motivators against a change: learning payments by pairing with Sam.

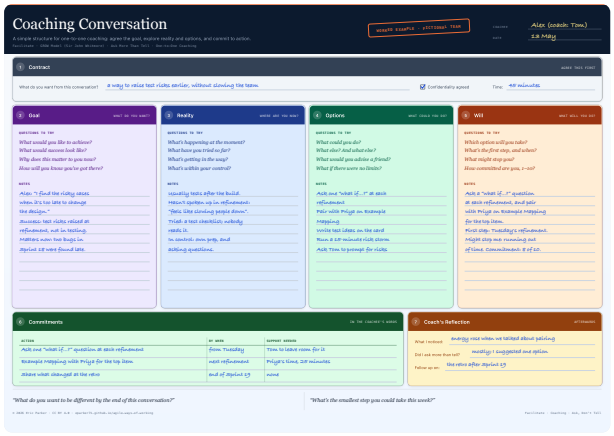
12 May



Impediments Board

Impediments from new to resolved, with an escalation ladder and what each one cost.

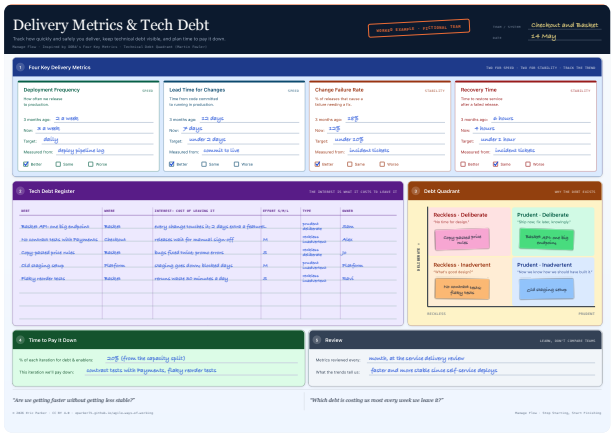
13 May



Coaching Conversation

Tom coaches Alex on raising test risks earlier; Alex commits to one “what if…?” per refinement.

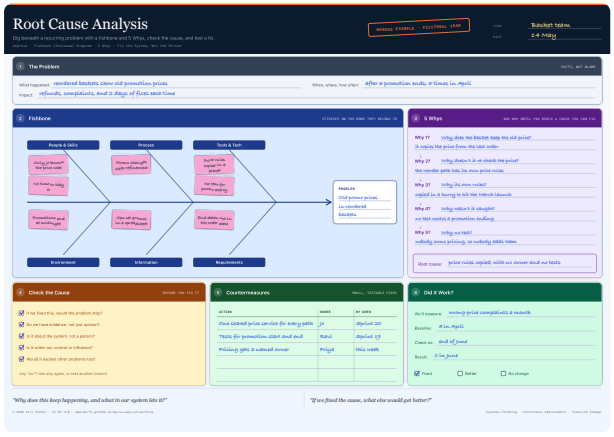
14 May



Delivery Metrics & Tech Debt

Faster and more stable since self-service deploys; five technical debts placed in the quadrant.

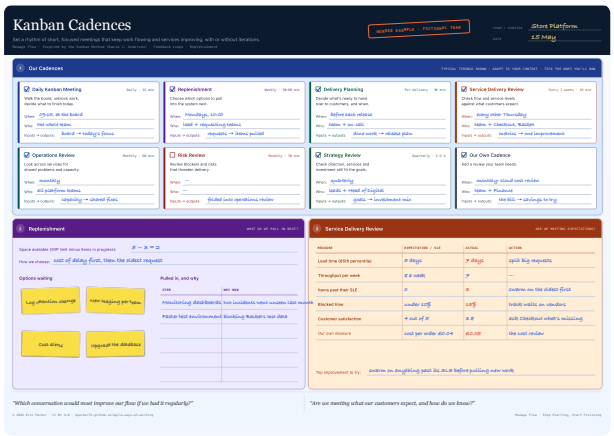
14 May



Root Cause Analysis

Old promo prices in reordered baskets, traced to copied price rules with no owner.

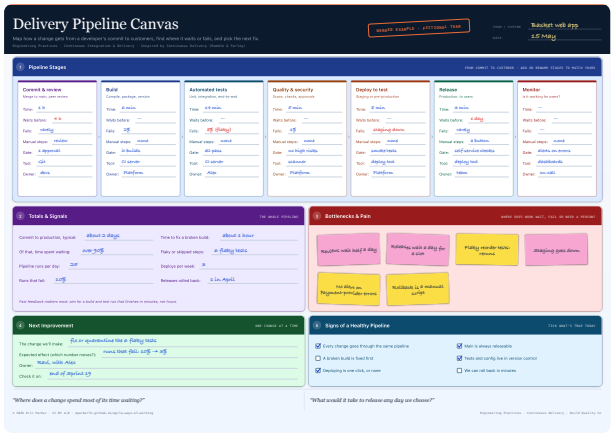
15 May



Kanban Cadences

Meanwhile the Store Platform team, working in flow, reviews its service against SLEs.

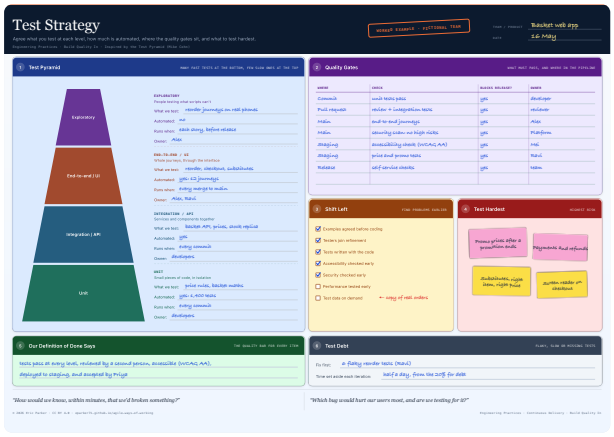
15 May



Delivery Pipeline Canvas

Seven pipeline stages: changes wait four hours for review and a day for release.

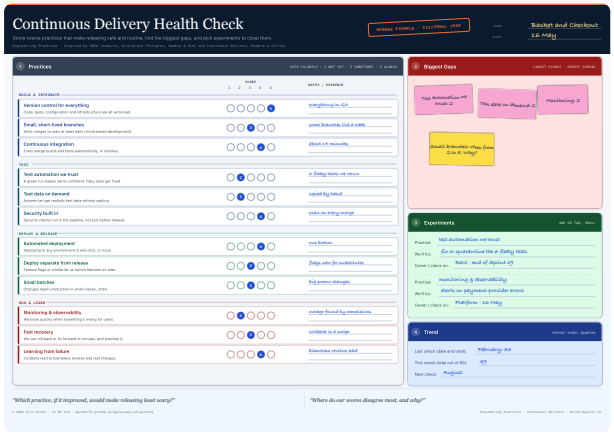
16 May



Test Strategy

What each level of the pyramid tests, seven quality gates, and where to test hardest.

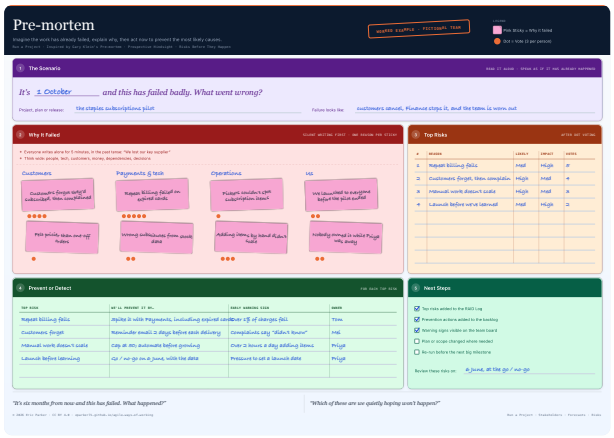
16 May



Continuous Delivery Health Check

Twelve practices scored: 39 out of 60, up from 33, with flaky tests and monitoring the gaps.

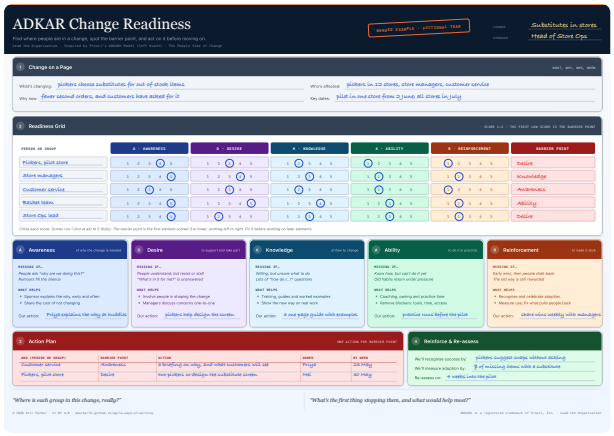
20 May



Pre-mortem

It's 1 October and the subscriptions pilot has failed. Why? Repeat billing tops the list.

21 May

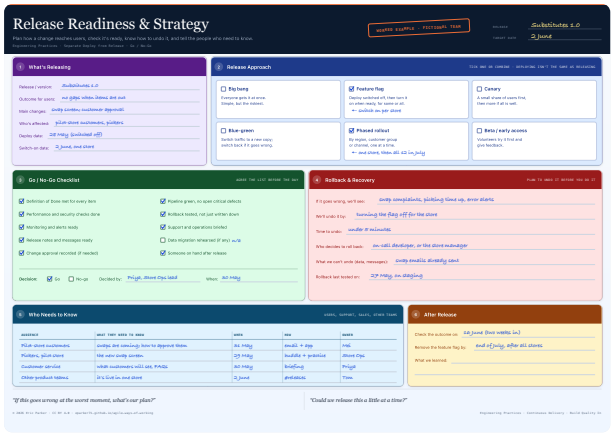


ADKAR Change Readiness

Rolling substitutes out to store pickers: each group's barrier point, and what to do about it.

June · Shipping

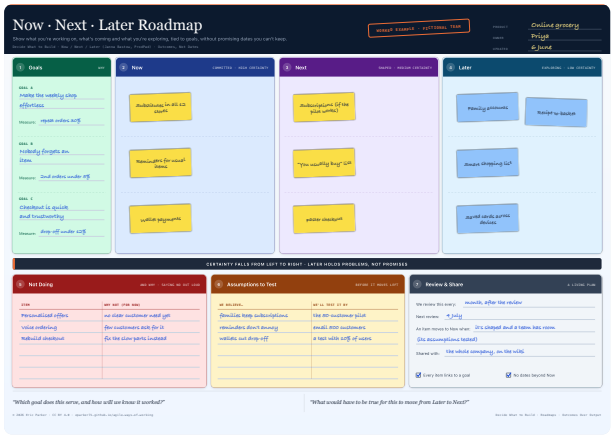
2 June



Release Readiness & Strategy

Substitutes 1.0 switches on in one store, behind a feature flag, with a tested rollback.

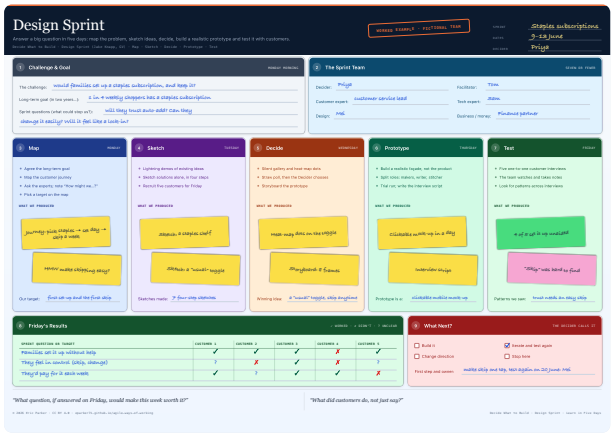
6 June



Now · Next · Later Roadmap

The roadmap after the pilot: substitutes everywhere now; subscriptions next, if the pilot works.

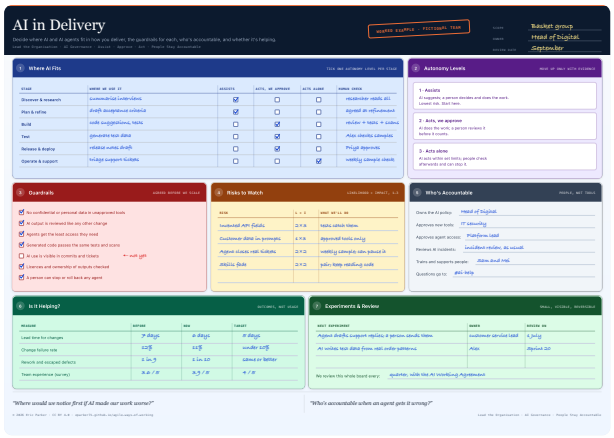
9–13 June



Design Sprint

Five days on staples subscriptions: four of five customers set it up, but skipping a week was hard.

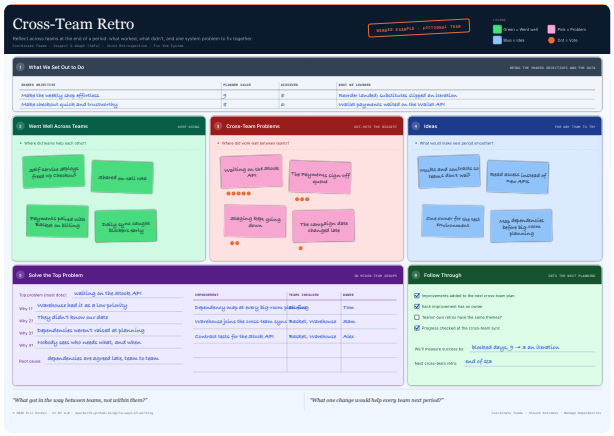
20 June



AI in Delivery

The group agrees where AI fits at each stage, how much it does alone, and who's accountable.

27 June

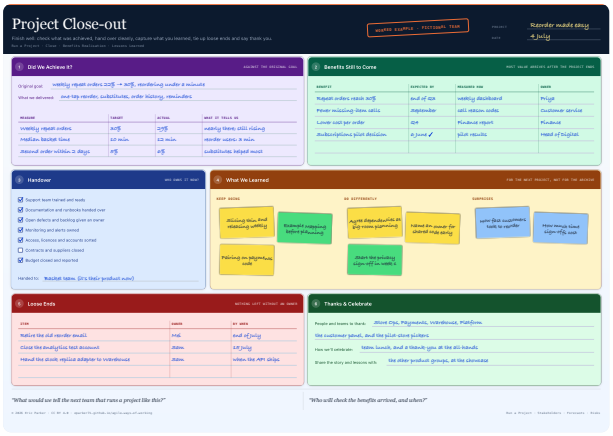


Cross-Team Retro

Five teams look back on the quarter: the top cross-team problem was waiting on the Stock API.

July · Finishing well

4 July



Project Close-out

Repeat orders reached 29%, nearly the 30% target. The team hands over, thanks people and records what it learned.

All names, numbers and events are made up, but the problems are real ones. For the tools grouped by job instead of by date, see the worked examples gallery; for situations rather than a story, see the Scenario Playbook.

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